

THE TRUTH ABOUT

Vaping

What e-cigarettes really do to your body — and why it matters most for young people.

An educational overview • [eccigirate](#)

What is vaping?

An e-cigarette heats a liquid into an aerosol you breathe in. That "vapor" is not water — it carries nicotine and other chemicals deep into your lungs.

1

Most contain nicotine

The same addictive drug found in cigarettes — often at high concentrations.

2

Not just "flavored water"

The aerosol can contain fine particles, heavy metals, and volatile chemicals.

3

Designed to be appealing

Sweet and fruity flavors drive most youth use.

70%+

of the aerosol's risk is invisible —
you can't see the chemicals you
inhale.

Vaping by the numbers

U.S. youth (middle & high school), most recent national survey data.

~2 million

middle & high school
students used a tobacco
product in 2025

1 in 13

high school students vaped
in the past 30 days (2024)

~29%

of teen vapers now puff
every day — nearly double
2020's rate

87%

of youth who vape use
flavored products

Sources: CDC & FDA National Youth Tobacco Survey (2024–2025 data).

What it does to your body

Nicotine and the other chemicals in vape aerosol affect several organs at once.

Lungs

- Acute lung injury (EVALI) linked to vaping chemicals
- Airway irritation, cough, and worsening asthma
- Evidence points to lasting lung damage over time

Heart

- Nicotine raises heart rate and blood pressure
- Blood vessels narrow, straining the heart
- Emerging research links some vapes to arrhythmia

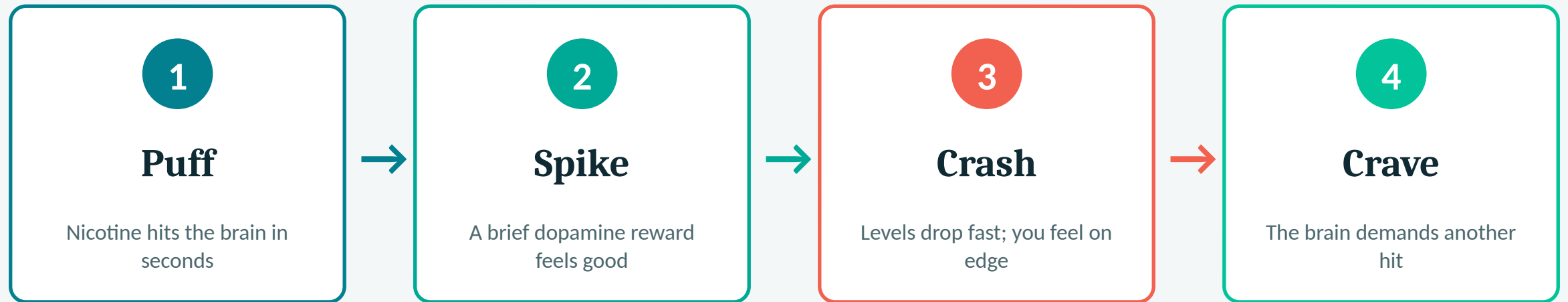
Brain

- Nicotine can harm brain development through age ~25
- Affects attention, learning, mood & impulse control
- High addiction potential, no cognitive benefit

Explore these as interactive 3D models on the [eccigirate](#) site.

Why it's so hard to stop

Nicotine creates a fast reward-and-crash loop that pushes you toward the next puff.



The younger you start, the faster and stronger dependence forms — the adolescent brain is especially sensitive to nicotine.

Myths vs. facts

MYTH

"It's just harmless water vapor."

FACT

It's an aerosol with nicotine, fine particles, and chemicals.

MYTH

"Vaping isn't addictive."

FACT

Most vapes contain nicotine — one of the most addictive substances.

MYTH

"It's totally safe because there's no smoke."

FACT

No smoke doesn't mean no harm — the lungs, heart, and brain are still affected.

MYTH

"Everyone my age vapes."

FACT

Most students don't — youth vaping has actually been declining.

Thinking about quitting?

Quitting is hard, but it works — and support makes it far more likely to stick.

1

Know your triggers

Notice the times, moods, and places that make you want to vape.

2

Tell someone you trust

A friend, parent, coach, or counselor makes quitting easier — you don't have to do it alone.

3

Use free support tools

Text-based quit programs and youth services are free and confidential.

4

Expect slip-ups

A slip isn't failure. Most people try more than once before quitting for good.

Free & confidential

This Is Quitting

Text "DITCHVAPE" to 88709

A free, text-based program from Truth Initiative built specifically for young people who want to quit vaping.

The bottom line

**No vape is safe — but the sooner you stop,
the more your body recovers.**

Learn more from trusted sources:

- › CDC — Youth & Tobacco: cdc.gov/tobacco
- › American Lung Association: lung.org
- › VFHY Prevention Lessons: vfhy.org/prevention-lessons